

Lecture 37 — Tenses | Past Continuous

Premium notes • Past Continuous — complete practical foundation

PAST CONTINUOUS

WAS / WERE

V4 / ING

POSITIVE

NEGATIVE

INTERROGATIVE

WH-QUESTIONS

Core idea

Past Continuous is used when an action was **continuing / in progress at a time in the past**.

जब किसी past time पर कोई व्यक्ति कोई काम **कर रहा था / चल रहा था**, तब Past Continuous का use किया जाता है।

I was teaching. • You were writing. • They were going.

1. Past Continuous की पहचान

Common Hindi sense: **रहा था / रही थी / रहे थे**.

मैं पढ़ा रहा था। → I was teaching.

आप लिख रहे थे। → You were writing.

वे कहीं जा रहे थे। → They were going.

I saw you yesterday. You were going to the market.

मैंने कल तुम्हें देखा था। तुम market जा रहे थे।

I was talking on the phone at that time.

मैं उस समय phone पर बात कर रहा था।

I was studying.

मैं पढ़ाई कर रहा था।

2. Main Structure

Positive Structure

Subject + was / were + V4 (verb + ing) + Object

Lesson terminology: **V4 = verb का -ing form.**

Subject	Helping Verb	Example
I / He / She / It / Singular Name	was	I was reading. / He was reading. / Sita was reading.
We / You / They / Plural	were	We were reading. / You were reading. / They were reading.

Memory formula

I → WAS | He/She/It/Name/Singular → WAS

We/You/They/Plural → WERE

3. Subject पहचानो, फिर WAS/WERE चुनो

Sentence में पूछें: **“कौन काम कर रहा था?”** जो answer मिले, वही subject है।

Subject	Correct	Example
I	was	I was teaching.
He / She / It	was	She was dancing.
Singular Name	was	Ram was reading.
We / You / They	were	They were playing.
Plural Subject	were	Students were studying.

4. Positive Sentences — Step by Step

मैं पढ़ा रहा था.

I → was → teach + ing

I was teaching.

हम पढ़ रहे थे.

We → were → read + ing

We were reading.

आप English बोल रहे थे.

You → were → speak + ing

You were speaking English.

I was playing a game.

I was dancing.

I was laughing.

I was teaching.

We were studying.

5. Plural Subjects + WERE

The kids were playing in the ground.

बच्चे ground में खेल रहे थे।

They were going.

वे जा रहे थे।

You were speaking English.

आप English बोल रहे थे।

We were reading.

हम पढ़ रहे थे।

Kids, students, boys, girls, people जैसे plural subjects के साथ **were** use करें.

6. Positive Practice

1. राम और श्याम झगड़ रहे थे.
2. Police चोर का पीछा कर रही थी.
3. तुम लोग मस्ती कर रहे थे.
4. वह mobile चला रही थी.
5. वह नाच रही थी.

Answers

1. **Ram and Shyam were quarrelling.**
2. **The police were chasing the thief.**
3. **You people were making fun.**
4. **She was using her mobile.**
5. **She was dancing.**

Two subjects joined by “and” are treated as plural in this lesson: **Ram and Shyam were...**

7. Negative Sentences

Structure

Subject + was / were + not + V4 + Object

She was not reading a book.

वह किताब नहीं पढ़ रही थी।

We were not riding a bike.

हम bike नहीं चला रहे थे।

We were not driving a car.

हम car नहीं चला रहे थे।

He was not talking to me.

वह मुझसे बात नहीं कर रहा था।

They were not preparing for school.

वे school की तैयारी नहीं कर रहे थे।

I was not helping my parents.

मैं अपने parents की मदद नहीं कर रहा था।

You were not going.

आप नहीं जा रहे थे।

You were not calling me.

आप मुझे phone नहीं कर रहे थे।

You were not swimming in the river.

आप नदी में तैर नहीं रहे थे।

Negative formula

was/were + not + V4

He was talking. → He was not talking.

They were playing. → They were not playing.

8. Interrogative Sentences

Structure

Was / Were + Subject + V4 + Object?

Were you coming?

क्या आप आ रहे थे?

Were you going?

क्या आप जा रहे थे?

Were you reading?

क्या आप पढ़ रहे थे?

Were you speaking English?

क्या आप English बोल रहे थे?

Were you thinking about it?

क्या आप इसके बारे में सोच रहे थे?

Were you cooking food?

क्या आप खाना बना रहे थे?

Were you taking a bath?

क्या आप नहा रहे थे?

Were you watching TV?

क्या तुम TV देख रहे थे?

Was he playing outside?

क्या वह बाहर खेल रहा था?

Were we running in the park?

क्या हम park में दौड़ रहे थे?

Was I speaking properly?

क्या मैं ठीक से बोल रहा था?

Was he waiting for you?

क्या वह आपका इंतजार कर रहा था?

9. WAS vs WERE — Master Chart

Subject	Past Continuous	Example
I	was	Was I reading?
He	was	Was he reading?
She	was	Was she reading?
It	was	Was it moving?
Singular name	was	Was Ram reading?
We	were	Were we reading?
You	were	Were you reading?
They	were	Were they reading?

Singular / I → WAS | Plural / You / We / They → WERE

10. Interrogative Negative

Structure

Was / Were + Subject + not + V4 + Object?

Was she not speaking the truth?

क्या वह सच नहीं बोल रही थी?

Were they not capturing pictures?

क्या वे pictures नहीं खींच रहे थे?

Was she not coming on time?

क्या वह समय पर नहीं आ रही थी?

Were the students not making noise?

क्या बच्चे शोर नहीं मचा रहे थे?

Was I not messaging you?

क्या मैं तुम्हें message नहीं कर रहा था?

11. WH-Questions

Structure

WH-word + was / were + Subject + V4 + Object?

What

What were you doing?

आप क्या कर रहे थे?

Why

Why was she writing?

वह क्यों लिख रही थी?

Where

Where was she going?

वह कहाँ जा रही थी?

How

How were you eating?

आप कैसे खा रहे थे?

When

When were you eating?

आप कब खा रहे थे?

Whom

Whom were you talking to?

आप किससे बात कर रहे थे?

What were you doing yesterday?

तुम कल क्या कर रहे थे?

Why was he crying in the school?

वह school में क्यों रो रहा था?

What were they playing in the playground?

वे playground में क्या खेल रहे थे?

Whom were you talking to at that time?

तुम उस समय किससे बात कर रहे थे?

Where was she going?

वह कहाँ जा रही थी?

WH-word note

Who को इस lesson में अलग structure की category बताया गया है, इसलिए यहाँ मुख्य practice What, Why, Where, How, When, Whom पर है.

12. One Verb, Many WH-Questions

Verb: EAT → EATING

What were you eating? = आप क्या खा रहे थे?

Why were you eating? = आप क्यों खा रहे थे?

Where were you eating? = आप कहाँ खा रहे थे?

How were you eating? = आप कैसे खा रहे थे?

When were you eating? = आप कब खा रहे थे?

एक ही helping-verb pattern में अलग-अलग WH-words लगाकर बहुत सारे questions frame किए जा सकते हैं।

13. Translation Practice — Family Scene

Hindi Paragraph

कल शाम मैं अपने कमरे में पढ़ रहा था। मेरी बहन बाहर खेल रही थी। माँ रसोई में खाना बना रही थी। पापा अखबार पढ़ रहे थे। बारिश भी हो रही थी। इसलिए हम घर के अंदर ही थे। मेरा दोस्त मुझे phone कर रहा था, लेकिन मैं उस समय अपना homework पूरा कर रहा था। TV पर एक अच्छी film चल रही थी। हम सब अपने-अपने काम कर रहे थे।

Model Translation

Yesterday evening, I was reading in my room. My sister was playing outside. Mother was cooking in the kitchen. Father was reading the newspaper. It was also raining, so we were inside the house.

My friend was calling me, but I was completing my homework at that time. A good movie was playing on TV. We were all doing our own work.

14. Speaking Strategy — Think → Translate → Speak

जो भी situation आपके सामने दिखे, उसे English में translate करने की कोशिश करें।

अपने mind में आने वाले thoughts को English में बोलने की habit बनाएं।

जो sentence नहीं आता, उसे note करें → बाद में उसका translation देखें → अगले दिन वही sentence बोलें।

Self-practice challenge

अगले **8–15 दिनों** तक daily situations को पहले English में frame करने की कोशिश करें। जितना बोलेंगे, उतना Past Continuous का structure natural होगा।

15. Vocabulary — 10 Useful Verbs

Verb	Meaning	Example
classify	वर्गीकृत करना	They were classifying the data.
coordinate	सामंजस्य बिठाना	They were coordinating the work.
emphasize	ज़ोर देना	She was emphasizing the point.
simplify	सरल करना	He was simplifying the topic.
specify	स्पष्ट/विशिष्ट रूप से बताना	They were specifying the details.
survey	सर्वेक्षण करना	We were surveying the area.
upgrade	बेहतर बनाना / upgrade करना	They were upgrading the system.
assemble	इकट्ठा / संगठित करना	They were assembling the parts.
generate	उत्पन्न / निर्माण करना	The team was generating ideas.
retain	संधारित करके रखना	They were retaining the information.

16. Practice Set

A. Positive

1. मैं कल पढ़ रहा था.
2. वह क्यों हँस रही थी? (convert later as WH)
3. हम अपने दोस्तों के साथ जा रहे थे.
4. वे मैदान में खेल रहे थे.
5. वह school जा रही थी.

B. Negative

1. वे मैदान में नहीं खेल रहे थे.
2. हम TV नहीं देख रहे थे.
3. वह खाना नहीं खा रही थी.
4. मैं अपने दोस्तों की मदद नहीं कर रहा था.
5. वह मुझसे बात नहीं कर रहा था.

C. Questions

1. क्या तुम मुझसे बात कर रहे थे?
2. क्या वह खाना खा रही थी?
3. बच्चे क्या कर रहे थे?
4. वह school क्यों जा रही थी?
5. वे कहाँ बैठ रहे थे?

17. Master Revision

Type	Structure	Example
Positive	Subject + was/were + V4	She was reading.
Negative	Subject + was/were + not + V4	She was not reading.
Interrogative	Was/Were + Subject + V4?	Was she reading?
Interrogative Negative	Was/Were + Subject + not + V4?	Was she not reading?
WH	WH + was/were + Subject + V4?	Why was she reading?

Fast memory map

Past + action in progress → WAS/WERE + V4

I / He / She / It / Singular → WAS

We / You / They / Plural → WERE

Negative → was/were + not + V4

Question → was/were first

WH → WH + was/were + subject + V4

Top mistakes

I were reading. ❌ → I was reading. ✅

They was playing. ❌ → They were playing. ✅

He was read. ❌ → He was reading. ✅

Were you went? ❌ → Were you going? ✅

Was she not sang? ❌ → Was she not singing? ✅

18. Homework

Task 1: 10 positive Past Continuous sentences बनाइए.

Task 2: 5 negative sentences बनाइए.

Task 3: 5 interrogative questions बनाइए.

Task 4: 5 interrogative-negative questions बनाइए.

Task 5: 5 WH-questions बनाइए using What, Why, Where, How, When.

Task 6: "Yesterday Evening" पर 8–10 lines का paragraph बोलें.

Task 7: आज की 10 vocabulary verbs के meaning याद करके प्रत्येक से एक sentence बोलें.

Final takeaway

Past Continuous = WAS/WERE + V4 (ING)

Past में ongoing action के लिए:

I/He/She/It/Name → was | We/You/They/Plural → were

बस structure याद रखें: **Subject → was/were → V4.**